

SLOT MACHINE WARMUP 2

Team 06

Larpmaxxing

PLAN FOR PROJECT

BATON PASS APPROACH

- Group divided into 5 pairs, each owning specific features
- Each pair takes full responsibility on it, from research to implementation
- Final version of work is passed to the next pair for integration of the project
- Subject file is avoided to avoid complications, and extreme high setting is used for optimization of code.

FURTHER UPDATES

- The reasoning setting for AI is dropped from **extreme high** to **high** in order to preserve tokens
- More detailed prompt usage was agreed upon during TA meeting (04/21)

APP FEATURE - KEVIN & SEAN

Research and goal: We evaluated on base features of online slot machines and aimed for incremental development on top of the 5x3 grid multiway award slot machine

Process: Due to high consumption of tokens, we simplified orders on extra features and concentrated our prompt on defining symbols, payline patterns, and numeric rewards.

Feature implementation:

- 5x3 grid reels
- multiway payline logic
- Auto-spin function
- paytable info page
- privacy term popup window
- special effect for high reward

Outcome: We managed to implement 5x3 grid reels and multiway payline logic with most of the extra features.

But there were limitations such as:

- Lack of visual optimization like unappealing slot animation and effects
- Redundancy on features ex) payline map, house rule explanation
- Unstructured coding with no comments

VISUAL THEMES- STEPHANIE & DISHITA

Research and goal:

- Researched what a slot machine UI should look like
- Created a cohesive slot machine color palette and ui design
- Identified theme-appropriate modern typography, animations and visual effects

Process: First, we added a cohesive typography, then replace the full color system, followed by adding visual effects and motion design, fixing animations, and finally implementing a theme system with light/dark modes.

Feature implementation:

- Typography system
- Casino themed UI color palette
- Visual effects and animations (e.g. reel spin)
- Light/dark mode system with theme toggle

Outcome: The main contribution here is polish and presentation. We added persistent light/dark theming, richer visual tokens, ambient sparkles, glow effects, and motion-based animation.

JARGON-MAXIME & AIDAN

Research and Goal:

- Research slot machine jargon and incorporate it in our application to give it a more realistic note
- Found a list of common slot machine terms along with their definition

Process:

- As a group, we had previously discussed using shorter prompts to limit token usage. For our section, we used short and effective prompts
- Following the meeting with our TA, we were recommended to use longer and descriptive prompts which the group upheld through the rest of the project
- The implementation of jargon was quite straightforward as it only required changing the text and added no new features
- We then tackled some layout issues by removing redundant features and reshaping the layout of the button to make the spin button look more appealing
- We prompted the creation of a README file to make the process of opening and playing the app intuitive

Outcome:

- The use of short prompts during our section definitively introduced randomness, this forced us to use more prompts to fix issues
- By the time we met with our TA, we had already finished implementing everything we wanted to, but had we began our section by using longer and more descriptive requests, we likely would have been able to use fewer prompts
- Our slot machine looked more refined with a more natural feel from the jargon

USERS - ARPITA & ETHAN

Research and Goal

In our research we saw that there were about 5 primary user segments: casual escapists, dedicated regulars, social connectors, VIPs, and Former real money gamblers. Bases on our user stories and the motivations we found, we added features to the ai prompts.

Process

First we added a daily bonus to reward users for continuous use and playing timer to have more responsible use of how long you've been on the app. We saw redundancy in the daily bonus so we simplified it, and added an invite friends feature. We added a used profile for personalization and made it higher stakes and fixed up the UI before handing it off.

Outcome

User profile, player name, icons and shared wallet. Daily bonus and play time tracking as well as invite friends feature. Though further personalized, this version has a lot of local interdependent states and currently the logic is entirely client side.

GAMIFICATION & ENGAGEMENT PATTERNS- ZAYN & NICHOLAS

Research and Goal:

- In order to increase player retention so people actually use the product for more than 5 minutes, we invested considerable time in researching gamification and engagement patterns. We found that features such as variable ratio reinforcement, bonus modifiers, visible progress bars, and near miss conditioning all drive high engagement out of players.

Process:

- The plan was to modularly implement one feature at a time, basically one feature per entry.
- Prompt 1: Variable Ratio Reinforcement (interesting, Codex refused to do this at first)
- Prompt 2: Buyable Bonuses
- Prompt 3: Near-miss Paylines
- Prompts 4 & 5 were used to clean up the final product, including all previous entries

Outcome:

- Game now contains multiple features that drive high engagement addictive behavior. Bonus multiplier with visuals can now be set for each spin, allowing higher risk betting and implicitly rewarding the player for spending more. Near-misses show players what rolls they *almost* had to get them to spin just one more time. Game feels unpredictable, wins/losses don't feel as stale